

IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	25 September 2026
Team ID	_____
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Brainstorming creates an open environment in which team members can freely share ideas without immediate judgement or criticism. The objective of this activity is to generate a wide range of possible solutions to the customer problem identified during the earlier stages of the Ideation Phase. Once generated, ideas are grouped into related categories, discussed as a team, evaluated against common criteria, and prioritized based on their relevance, feasibility, user value, and potential impact.

This brainstorming activity builds on the outcomes of the Empathize & Discover stage and the Define the Problem Statements stage, in which stakeholder needs and pain points were studied and documented. The purpose of this document is to move the team's thinking systematically from the identified problem, through a broad set of ideas, to a single proposed concept that can be taken forward for detailed requirement analysis.

The overall flow followed in this activity is: **Problem → Ideas → Concept.**

Reference (structural inspiration only): <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

The team came together to review the stakeholder findings and the problem statements identified during the earlier Ideation activities. Each team member shared observations gathered during stakeholder discussions, and the group discussed which problems most consistently appeared across the request management process.

The key stakeholders considered during this discussion were:

- End Users / Network Requesters
- IT Administrators
- Network Fulfillment Team
- Approvers / Security Approvers

The team then discussed the major problems affecting these stakeholders, summarized in the table below.

Problem ID	Problem	Affected Stakeholder	Impact
PS-1	Users may find it difficult to identify the correct network request type and provide all required information.	End Users	Incomplete or delayed requests
PS-2	Users may have limited visibility into the status and progress of network requests.	End Users	Repeated status follow-ups
PS-3	Network fulfillment teams may receive incomplete or inconsistent request information.	Fulfillment Team	Rework and delays in fulfillment

Problem ID	Problem	Affected Stakeholder	Impact
PS-4	IT administrators may spend significant effort on manual coordination, routing, and follow-ups.	IT Administrators	Increased administrative workload
PS-5	Approvers may experience difficulty with manual or inconsistent approval communication.	Approvers	Approval delays and miscommunication

Selected Problem Statement (focus of this brainstorming activity):

"Network requesters and fulfillment stakeholders need a clear, consistent, and transparent way to manage network requests, because manual or fragmented processes can result in incomplete information, repeated communication, approval delays, and limited visibility into request progress."

This problem was selected as the focus for this brainstorming activity for the following reasons:

- It affects multiple stakeholders across the request lifecycle.
- It occurs across different stages of the process, from submission to closure.
- It creates several opportunities for process improvement.
- It can be explored through multiple possible approaches.
- It is directly relevant to the objectives of this project.

Step-2: Brainstorming and Idea Generation

Before generating ideas, the team agreed on the following brainstorming rules:

1. Generate as many relevant ideas as possible.
2. Do not reject an idea during the initial generation stage.
3. Encourage practical as well as creative ideas.
4. Build on ideas suggested by other team members.
5. Focus on solving the selected customer problem.
6. Consider the needs of all stakeholders.
7. Avoid selecting a final solution too early.
8. Group similar ideas after brainstorming.

At this stage, quantity of ideas is encouraged before detailed evaluation. Evaluation and prioritization are performed only after sufficient alternatives have been generated.

Step-3: How Might We Questions

The team framed the selected problem as a set of "How Might We" (HMW) questions to open up creative thinking:

1. HMW-1: How might we simplify the process of submitting network requests?
2. HMW-2: How might we ensure that users provide complete and accurate request information?
3. HMW-3: How might we reduce manual coordination between requesters, IT teams, network teams, and approvers?
4. HMW-4: How might we improve approval visibility and reduce unnecessary delays?
5. HMW-5: How might we provide users with clear visibility into request status?

6. HMW-6: How might we reduce repetitive administrative work?
7. HMW-7: How might we maintain a consistent history of requests, approvals, and fulfillment activities?
8. HMW-8: How might we support different types of network requests through a standardized process?

Step-4: Generate Ideas

Using the HMW questions as a starting point, the team generated the following ideas specific to the proposed Automated Network Request Management concept in ServiceNow.

No.	Idea	Description	Problem Addressed	Stakeholder Benefit
1	Network Service Catalog	A proposed single catalog page listing all available network-related request items.	PS-1	Easier identification of the correct request type
2	Network Request Categories	Idea to group requests such as VPN, Firewall, VLAN, and IP under clear categories.	PS-1	Faster and more accurate request selection
3	Guided Request Forms	Step-by-step guided forms that walk the requester through required details.	PS-1	Reduced confusion during submission
4	Dynamic Form Fields	Form fields that could change based on the selected request type.	PS-1, PS-3	More relevant and simpler forms
5	Mandatory Field Validation	Idea to enforce completion of critical fields before submission.	PS-3	Fewer incomplete requests
6	Conditional Field Display	Show or hide fields depending on earlier answers in the form.	PS-1	Cleaner, less overwhelming forms
7	Automated Approval Routing	Automatically route requests to the correct approver based on request type.	PS-4, PS-5	Less manual coordination for administrators
8	Manager Approval	Idea to include the requester's manager in the approval chain where required.	PS-5	Proper managerial oversight
9	Security Approval	Idea to route sensitive requests (e.g., firewall, VPN) to a security approver.	PS-5	Stronger governance and compliance
10	Approval Reminder Notifications	Automated reminders sent to approvers for pending approvals.	PS-5	Fewer approval delays
11	Automatic Assignment Group Routing	Idea to automatically assign fulfillment tasks to the correct network team.	PS-4	Reduced manual routing effort
12	Automatic Network Fulfillment Task Creation	System-generated fulfillment tasks once a request is approved.	PS-3, PS-4	Consistent and timely task creation
13	Email Notifications	Automated email updates at key stages of the request lifecycle.	PS-2	Better communication with requesters
14	Request Status Tracking	A proposed way for users to view real-time status of their requests.	PS-2	Reduced status follow-up queries

No.	Idea	Description	Problem Addressed	Stakeholder Benefit
15	SLA Monitoring	Idea to track requests against defined service level timelines.	PS-2, PS-4	Improved accountability and turnaround
16	Escalation Mechanism	Automatic escalation of requests that exceed expected timelines.	PS-2, PS-4	Fewer stalled requests
17	Request History	A consolidated view of past requests raised by a user or team.	PS-2	Easier reference and reuse of past requests
18	Audit Trail	Idea to maintain a record of all actions taken on a request.	PS-3	Improved traceability and governance
19	Network Request Dashboard	A proposed dashboard summarizing open, pending, and closed requests.	PS-2, PS-4	Better visibility for administrators
20	Network Request Analytics	Idea to analyze request volume, types, and turnaround time trends.	PS-4	Data-driven process improvement
21	Knowledge Article Suggestions	Suggest relevant knowledge articles while a user fills a request.	PS-1	Reduced need for manual guidance
22	Change Request Integration	Idea to link relevant network requests with existing change processes.	PS-3	Better alignment with governance processes
23	Automated Closure Notification	Notify requesters automatically once a request is completed.	PS-2	Clear communication of completion
24	Duplicate Request Identification	Idea to flag potentially duplicate requests before submission.	PS-3	Reduced redundant fulfillment effort
25	Network Fulfillment Queue	A proposed queue view for the fulfillment team to manage pending tasks.	PS-3, PS-4	Organized and prioritized fulfillment work

Step-5: Group Similar Ideas

After the initial brainstorming, the team grouped similar ideas into common solution areas using an affinity-mapping approach. This helped identify natural themes within the larger set of ideas.

Idea Category	Related Ideas	Main Objective
Request Intake	Network Service Catalog; Network Request Categories; Guided Request Forms	Simplify how requests are initiated
Data Collection	Dynamic Form Fields; Mandatory Field Validation; Conditional Fields	Ensure complete and accurate request information
Approval	Automated Approval Routing; Manager Approval; Security Approval; Approval Reminders	Streamline and speed up approvals
Fulfillment	Assignment Group Routing; Automatic Fulfillment Tasks; Network Fulfillment Queue	Organize and route fulfillment work

Idea Category	Related Ideas	Main Objective
Communication	Email Notifications; Approval Notifications; Closure Notifications	Keep stakeholders informed at each stage
Tracking	Request Status Tracking; SLA Monitoring; Escalation; Request History	Provide visibility into progress and timelines
Governance	Audit Trail; Change Request Integration	Maintain traceability and compliance
Analytics	Network Request Dashboard; Request Analytics	Support data-driven process insights

Step-6: Evaluate the Generated Ideas

Following grouping, the team evaluated the generated ideas as a group discussion, using a common set of criteria. Each criterion was scored on a 1-to-5 scale to allow relative comparison between ideas.

User Value: The extent to which the idea directly improves the experience of the network requester.

Business Value: The extent to which the idea supports organizational efficiency and process improvement.

Automation Potential: How well the idea can reduce manual effort through automation within ServiceNow.

Technical Feasibility: How realistic the idea is to explore further using ServiceNow capabilities.

Scalability: Whether the idea can support increasing request volumes and future request types.

Security / Compliance Value: The extent to which the idea supports governance, approval integrity, and traceability.

Scoring scale used: 1 = Very Low, 2 = Low, 3 = Medium, 4 = High, 5 = Very High.

These scores represent project-team prioritization judgements made during the ideation activity. They are not measurements of actual production performance, and are intended only to guide discussion on which ideas to carry forward.

Step-7: Idea Prioritization Matrix

The team scored the most significant ideas against the evaluation criteria to compare them on a common basis.

Idea	User Value	Business Value	Automation	Feasibility	Scalability	Security	Total
Network Service Catalog	5	4	4	5	4	3	25
Dynamic Request Forms	5	4	4	4	4	3	24
Mandatory Field Validation	4	4	4	5	4	3	24
Automated Approval Routing	5	5	5	3	4	4	26
Automatic Task Creation	4	5	5	3	4	3	24
Assignment Group Routing	4	4	4	4	4	3	23
Notifications	4	3	4	5	4	2	22
Request Status Tracking	5	4	4	4	4	2	23
SLA Monitoring	4	4	3	3	4	3	21

Idea	User Value	Business Value	Automation	Feasibility	Scalability	Security	Total
Audit Trail	3	4	3	4	4	5	23
Dashboard	4	4	3	4	4	2	21
Change Integration	3	3	2	2	3	4	17

The ideas with stronger combined scores are considered suitable candidates for inclusion in the proposed concept, subject to detailed requirements and feasibility analysis.

Step-8: Impact vs Feasibility

To further guide prioritization, the team classified the ideas using an Impact-versus-Feasibility view. This classification helps the team understand which ideas can form the initial concept and which may require additional analysis before being taken forward.

Classification	Ideas
High Impact / High Feasibility	Network Service Catalog; Guided Forms; Mandatory Validation; Automated Notifications; Status Tracking
High Impact / Medium Feasibility	Automated Approval Routing; Automatic Fulfillment Task Creation; Audit Integration
Medium Impact / High Feasibility	Knowledge Guidance; Basic Dashboard; Request History
Medium Impact / Medium Feasibility	Advanced Analytics; Change Integration; Advanced Escalation

Step-9: Proposed Concept

Based on the grouping, evaluation, and prioritization activities above, the team combined the strongest related ideas into a single proposed concept: "Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow". This concept brings together several related ideas into one end-to-end request management process, rather than treating each idea in isolation.

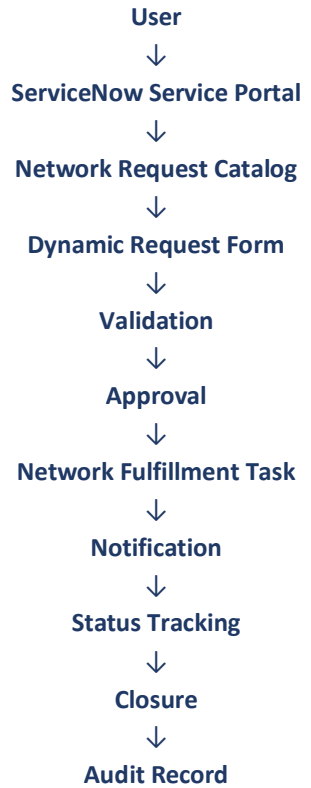
The proposed concept includes the following elements:

1. Standardized Network Request Catalog
2. Guided and Dynamic Forms
3. Required Field Validation
4. Automated Approval Routing
5. Automated Fulfillment Task Creation
6. Assignment to Network Team
7. Automated Notifications
8. Request Status Tracking
9. Audit History
10. Reporting and Analytics

This is the concept selected for further requirement analysis, and it will be refined during subsequent project phases before any development or configuration activity begins.

Step-10: Conceptual Workflow

At a high level, the proposed concept follows the sequence outlined below.



Stage	Description
User	The requester begins the process by accessing the service portal.
ServiceNow Service Portal	The proposed entry point through which users would reach the network request catalog.
Network Request Catalog	A proposed listing of available network request types for the user to choose from.
Dynamic Request Form	A guided form idea that adapts based on the selected request type.
Validation	Idea to check that mandatory information is complete before submission.
Approval	Proposed automated routing of the request to the relevant approver(s).
Network Fulfillment Task	A proposed task automatically created for the network team once approved.
Notification	Automated updates proposed to keep stakeholders informed.
Status Tracking	A proposed view allowing the requester to monitor progress.
Closure	The point at which the fulfillment work is marked complete.
Audit Record	A proposed historical record retained for traceability and reporting.

This workflow represents a conceptual, high-level view only. It does not describe technical configuration and is intended to guide further requirement discussions.

Step-11: Proposed Network Request Types

As part of the proposed concept, the team identified an initial, non-exhaustive set of network request categories for further requirements analysis. These are proposed catalog items and are subject to refinement in later phases.

Request Type	Purpose	Possible Information Required	Possible Approval
VPN Access Request	Request remote VPN access for a user or device.	User details, access duration, business justification	Manager and Security Approval
Firewall Rule Request	Request a new or modified firewall rule.	Source/destination details, port, business justification	Security Approval
Network Access Request	Request access to a specific network or system segment.	User details, target network, justification	Manager Approval
IP Address Request	Request allocation of a new IP address.	Purpose, device details, location	IT Administrator Approval
VLAN Request	Request creation or modification of a VLAN.	Department, purpose, affected locations	Network Team Approval
Port Activation Request	Request activation of a network port.	Location, device type, justification	IT Administrator Approval
Network Change Request	Request a broader change to network configuration.	Change description, impact, timeline	Change Advisory / Security Approval

Step-12: Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Outcome

- The team reviewed the identified customer problems from the earlier Ideation Phase activities.
- One focus problem was selected for this brainstorming activity.
- Multiple solution ideas were generated in response to the selected problem.
- Ideas were grouped into meaningful categories using affinity mapping.
- Ideas were evaluated using a common set of criteria.
- Feasible and valuable ideas were identified for further consideration.
- These ideas were combined into the proposed Automated Network Request Management concept.
- The concept will be taken into the next project phase for detailed requirements analysis and planning.